

Your Brain Treats Spending Like a Drug (And It Knows Exactly When to Strike)

133 BEATS · full generated prompts, one per beat, in filename order

STYLE PREAMBLE (implicit across all prompts below):

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only, plain solid white background (black scenes only for the opening night beats), no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside.

PART 1 of 4 — Beats 1–34

BEAT 1 — 00m00s-00m05s

The screen lights up Alex's face in the dark. 11:47pm, Friday.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, extremely dark scene: plain solid BLACK background, everything pure black except Alex's face lit by a cold blue-white glow coming from below/off-frame (a phone screen). 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head (only the lit portion visible against black), two small black dot eyes wide open, an unreadable half-smile (not neutral), small blue rectangle t-shirt patch barely visible in the dim light. The transparent oval patch on top of his head is completely DARK and empty right now — no brain villain visible yet, dormant, waiting. EXTREME CLOSE-UP on his lit face only. No text, no props visible yet.

file: 001_00m00s-00m05s.png

BEAT 2 — 00m05s-00m11s

"24-HOUR SALE — 30% OFF. ENDS TONIGHT." His thumb moves before he's finished reading it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, plain solid BLACK background, everything pure black except Alex's lit face and phone screen glow. 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head lit by cold blue-white phone glow, two small black dot eyes now snapping wide open and alert, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch. Same extreme close-up framing as before, but now a phone screen (glowing pale blue rectangle) fills more of the frame in the foreground with bold black marker banner text on it: "24-HOUR SALE — 30% OFF. ENDS TONIGHT." The instant this appears, the transparent oval patch on top of his head lights up with a sudden bright PINK glow, a small pink blob "brain villain" character visible inside now, eyes snapping open, alert smirk, small radiating glow lines around the patch. No other text besides the banner.

file: 002_00m05s-00m11s.png

BEAT 3 — 00m11s-00m16s

He doesn't buy. Not yet — not for three more hours.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, plain solid BLACK background, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, white), 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM-STYLE SCENE. A simple glowing clock face doodle icon showing "11:47 PM" in bold white/blue marker digits, prominent on one side of the frame. A small simple dark silhouette of Alex (just an outline, standing still, no detail) waits motionless beside the clock. A faint ghosted hourglass icon nearby suggests time passing. No other text besides the clock digits.

file: 003_00m11s-00m16s.png

BEAT 4 — 00m16s-00m19s

At 2:50am, he finally taps "confirm order."

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, plain solid BLACK background, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, white, red), 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on his head glowing pink with the brain villain blob inside (smirking). A glowing clock doodle icon now shows "2:50 AM" in bold white/blue marker digits beside him. His thumb presses a phone screen button labeled "CONFIRM ORDER" in bold black marker capitals. No other text.

file: 004_00m16s-00m19s.png

BEAT 5 — 00m19s-00m24s

Ask him when he decided, and he'll say right now. 2:50am.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, plain solid BLACK background, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, white, red), 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on his head glowing pink with the brain villain blob inside. His thumb is mid-press on a phone screen button labeled "CONFIRM ORDER". A thick curling red rewind arrow starts from his thumb and curves backward through the air toward a small inset of the glowing notification banner "24-HOUR SALE" in the corner of the frame. No other text.

file: 005_00m19s-00m24s.png

BEAT 6 — 00m24s-00m30s

He's wrong. The decision happened at 11:47pm — the instant the screen lit up.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, plain solid BLACK background, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, white), 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. CLOSE-UP on Alex's transparent skull patch, glowing bright pink. Inside it, the brain villain blob has small simple crossed-arm doodles added, a satisfied smug smirk, as if it already collected payment. The thick curling red rewind arrow from the previous beat lands directly on the villain here. No other text.

file: 006_00m24s-00m30s.png

BEAT 7 — 00m30s-00m36s

Three hours he didn't need. The transaction was already finished, in his head.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, plain solid BLACK background, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink, white), 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. WIDE SHOT. On the left, a small relaxed pink brain-villain-blob character (with simple little legs added just for this shot) walks away off-frame, small motion lines behind it, satisfied posture. On the right, Alex's arm and hand are frozen mid-tap on a glowing phone screen, visually out of sync with the villain — the villain already leaving before Alex's action is even finished. No text.

file: 007_00m30s-00m36s.png

BEAT 8 — 00m36s-00m43s

By the time money changed hands, his brain had already cashed in and left the building.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, plain solid BLACK background, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink, white, green), 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. WIDE SHOT, continuing the previous scene. A small euro-coin doodle icon travels from Alex's frozen phone screen toward the small pink brain-villain-blob character, now even further away near the edge of the frame, already exiting. Alex's hand remains frozen mid-tap on the right. No text.

file: 008_00m36s-00m43s.png

BEAT 9 — 00m43s-00m48s

Multiply that by every notification this year, and the pattern gets expensive fast.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple calendar-page doodle icon with small red dots scattered across several nights/boxes, each red dot rendered as a tiny bell-icon (notification). The dots visibly cluster and multiply toward the bottom of the page, showing the pattern growing. No text.

file: 009_00m43s-00m48s.png

BEAT 10 — 00m48s-00m52s

Here's what nobody tells you about impulse spending.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside (back to the standard daylight look, no longer glowing). MEDIUM SHOT. Alex shrugs with one hand up, addressing the viewer directly, a small black-outlined thought/question mark doodle above his head. No text.

file: 010_00m48s-00m52s.png

BEAT 11 — 00m52s-00m55s

It's not that you're weak at 3am.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex with a black-outlined thought bubble above his head containing bold marker text "WEAK AT 3AM?" struck through with a thick red marker "X". No other text.

file: 011_00m52s-00m55s.png

BEAT 12 — 00m55s-01m01s

It's that your brain already got its reward before you ever paid for anything.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, gold, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple horizontal timeline. A small glowing star/reward-coin doodle icon sits early on the left side of the timeline. A shopping-bag doodle icon (payment) sits later on the right side. A bracket shows the reward arriving well before the payment. No text.

file: 012_00m55s-01m01s.png

BEAT 13 — 01m01s-01m04s

Three traps run this system. Not one.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Three simple bear-trap doodle icons in a row, each labeled with a bold black marker number "1", "2", "3" underneath. Evenly spaced, no other text.

file: 013_01m01s-01m04s.png

BEAT 14 — 01m04s-01m07s

The first one feels like excitement.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex looks excited, wide eyes, big open-mouth smile, small sparkle doodle marks around his head. A small bear-trap doodle icon labeled "1" sits nearby on the ground. No text.

file: 014_01m04s-01m07s.png

BEAT 15 — 01m07s-01m09s

The second one feels like relief.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex exhales in relief, shoulders relaxed, eyes closed contentedly, small "phew" motion lines near his head. A small bear-trap doodle icon labeled "2" sits nearby on the ground. No text.

file: 015_01m07s-01m09s.png

BEAT 16 — 01m09s-01m15s

The third one — the one nobody suspects — feels like moving on.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex walks casually away, one hand in pocket, relaxed shrugging body language, small motion lines behind him suggesting he's moving on. A small bear-trap doodle icon labeled "3" sits nearby on the ground, half-hidden under a small blanket doodle. No text.

file: 016_01m09s-01m15s.png

BEAT 17 — 01m15s-01m20s

Let's time this out to the minute, so nothing gets rewritten later.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex points firmly at a large stopwatch doodle icon with a precise thin second-hand, determined focused expression. No text.

file: 017_01m15s-01m20s.png

BEAT 18 — 01m20s-01m28s

Six months ago, Alex got the same kind of notification. He didn't buy anything that day either.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex looks at his phone with a small notification banner icon, calm neutral expression (not buying), a small calendar tag beside him reading "6 MONTHS AGO". No other text.

file: 018_01m20s-01m28s.png

BEAT 19 — 01m28s-01m35s

His heart rate still climbed. His thumb still reached for the phone before his brain caught up.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex's hand reaching toward a phone just out of frame, a small heart-icon with a rising pulse-line doodle beside him showing his heart rate climbing. No text.

file: 019_01m28s-01m35s.png

BEAT 20 — 01m35s-01m43s

Wolfram Schultz — University of Cambridge — ran an experiment with monkeys, a light, and a squirt of juice.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple doodle bust/portrait silhouette (round head, minimal simple lines, no detailed face) labeled below in bold black marker "SCHULTZ". A small building icon tag "CAMBRIDGE" beside it, and small tiny doodle icons of a monkey, a lightbulb, and a juice-drop nearby. No other text.

file: 020_01m35s-01m43s.png

BEAT 21 — 01m43s-01m48s

Every time the light came on, juice followed two seconds later.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple monkey doodle icon sits beside a lightbulb doodle icon that is lit up/glowing, and a juice-drop doodle icon arriving after it with a small tag reading "2 SEC" between them. No other text.

file: 021_01m43s-01m48s.png

BEAT 22 — 01m48s-01m52s

Schultz measured the monkeys' dopamine neurons the entire time.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference. Add a small neuron/squiggly-brain-wave icon overlaid on the monkey, plus a small measuring graph-line icon nearby. No text.

file: 022_01m48s-01m52s.png

BEAT 23 — 01m52s-01m56s

At first, the neurons fired when the juice arrived.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference, with a small red spark/firing-burst doodle drawn right at the juice-drop icon, showing the neuron fires there. No text.

file: 023_01m52s-01m56s.png

BEAT 24 — 01m56s-01m59s

After a few repetitions, something changed.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference, with a small repeat/loop-arrow doodle icon and a small question mark floating above the scene, suggesting repetition and change. No text.

file: 024_01m56s-01m59s.png

BEAT 25 — 01m59s-02m02s

The neurons stopped firing for the juice.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference, but now the firing-spark burst at the juice-drop icon is crossed out with a thick red "X" and drawn faded/dim, showing the neurons stopped firing there. No text.

file: 025_01m59s-02m02s.png

BEAT 26 — 02m02s-02m04s

They fired for the light.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference, but now the red spark/firing-burst doodle has moved onto the lightbulb icon instead of the juice-drop. No text.

file: 026_02m02s-02m04s.png

BEAT 27 — 02m04s-02m10s

Not a metaphor. A measured shift in exactly which moment produces the chemical.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference, with a small ruler/measuring-tape doodle icon overlaid across the scene, emphasizing a precise measured shift. No text.

file: 027_02m04s-02m10s.png

BEAT 28 — 02m10s-02m12s

Researchers call this reward prediction error.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9 title card composition, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. TITLE CARD. Bold oversized black marker text "REWARD PREDICTION ERROR" centered on plain white background. No other text.

file: 028_02m10s-02m12s.png

BEAT 29 — 02m12s-02m17s

The brain doesn't reward you for getting what you expected.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon, with a checkmark doodle icon beside it struck through with a thick red marker "X", showing the expected reward does not trigger it. No text.

file: 029_02m12s-02m17s.png

BEAT 30 — 02m17s-02m22s

It rewards you for the signal that something good might be coming.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon with a glowing lightbulb/signal doodle icon beside it and a bold checkmark, showing the brain rewards the signal itself. No text.

file: 030_02m17s-02m22s.png

BEAT 31 — 02m22s-02m24s

We call this the Maybe Hit.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9 title card composition, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. TITLE CARD. Bold oversized black marker text "THE MAYBE HIT" centered, with a small glowing lightbulb-and-spark doodle icon in the bottom corner. No other text.

file: 031_02m22s-02m24s.png

BEAT 32 — 02m24s-02m27s

That's what happened to Alex at 11:47pm.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same glowing clock icon showing "11:47 PM" as reference 1, with the small "THE MAYBE HIT" title tag from reference 2 attached beside it as a label. No other text besides the clock digits and the title tag.

file: 032_02m24s-02m27s.png

BEAT 33 — 02m27s-02m32s

The notification was the light. The 30% discount was the juice.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The notification banner icon from reference 1 connected by a bold black marker "=" equals sign to the lightbulb icon from reference 2; below it, a "30% OFF" discount tag connected by "=" to the juice-drop icon from reference 2. No other text.

file: 033_02m27s-02m32s.png

BEAT 34 — 02m32s-02m37s

His dopamine had already fired in bed, three hours before checkout.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside, glowing bright pink. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex lying in a simple bed doodle, skull patch glowing pink, small tag beside him reading "3 HOURS BEFORE". No other text.

file: 034_02m32s-02m37s.png

PART 2 of 4 — Beats 35–67

BEAT 35 — 02m37s-02m39s

Not because he's impulsive.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Bold black marker word "IMPULSIVE" struck through with a thick red marker "X". No other text.

file: 035_02m37s-02m39s.png

BEAT 36 — 02m39s-02m44s

But because his brain already got paid the moment the "maybe" appeared.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, gold), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple horizontal timeline with a small notification/bell icon on it. A euro-coin doodle icon lands exactly on top of the notification icon, showing the reward paid right there. No text.

file: 036_02m39s-02m44s.png

BEAT 37 — 02m44s-02m48s

This isn't a lack of self-control. This is neuroscience.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon labeled "NEUROSCIENCE" in bold black marker, with a separate label "SELF-CONTROL" struck through with a thick red "X" beside it. No other text.

file: 037_02m44s-02m48s.png

BEAT 38 — 02m48s-02m52s

The purchase itself, at 2:50am, was almost chemically irrelevant.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same glowing clock icon showing "2:50 AM" as reference, now drawn faded and washed-out with a small stamp doodle over it reading "IRRELEVANT". No other text.

file: 038_02m48s-02m52s.png

BEAT 39 — 02m52s-02m57s

The Brain Villain had already collected its reward and left the room.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. WIDE SHOT, same scene as reference: the small pink brain-villain-blob character walking away off-frame satisfied, Alex's arm frozen mid-tap on the phone. Add a small simple exit-door doodle icon where the villain is heading. No text.

file: 039_02m52s-02m57s.png

BEAT 40 — 02m57s-03m02s

That's the first trap. It doesn't feel like a chemical event.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "1" as reference, with a bold black marker label "CHEMICAL EVENT" beside it struck through with a thick red "X". No other text.

file: 040_02m57s-03m02s.png

BEAT 41 — 03m02s-03m04s

It feels like excitement.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "1" as reference, with a bold black marker label "EXCITEMENT" beside it, circled/highlighted to show it is the accepted label. No other text.

file: 041_03m02s-03m04s.png

BEAT 42 — 03m04s-03m09s

If your brain is doing this to you right now — subscribe.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex enthusiastically points with both hands at a simple bell doodle icon (subscribe bell), big excited smile. No other text.

file: 042_03m04s-03m09s.png

BEAT 43 — 03m09s-03m12s

We break down a new bias every week.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple calendar-grid doodle icon with a small bear-trap icon stamped on one box per week across the calendar, matching the trap icon style from reference. No other text.

file: 043_03m09s-03m12s.png

BEAT 44 — 03m12s-03m13s

It's free.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex holds an empty wallet turned inside out, smiling, with a big bold black marker tag reading "FREE" beside him. No other text.

file: 044_03m12s-03m13s.png

BEAT 45 — 03m13s-03m17s

And it might save you more than you think.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex holds a small piggy-bank doodle icon protectively in both arms, thoughtful expression, a small euro symbol floating above it. No other text.

file: 045_03m13s-03m17s.png

BEAT 46 — 03m17s-03m21s

Two days after the sale, the package arrived.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex receives a simple cardboard-box doodle package at a door, small calendar tag beside him reading "2 DAYS". No other text.

file: 046_03m17s-03m21s.png

BEAT 47 — 03m21s-03m25s

Alex felt genuinely happy opening it. For about a day.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, brown, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex smiles brightly opening the same cardboard-box package as reference, small confetti/sparkle doodle marks around him, a small tag reading "DAY 1". No other text.

file: 047_03m21s-03m25s.png

BEAT 48 — 03m25s-03m29s

By day three, the item was just there. Furniture. Background.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, brown, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. The same item from the package sits ignored and gray in the background, Alex walks past without looking at it, neutral expression, a small tag reading "DAY 3", no sparkles or confetti this time. No other text.

file: 048_03m25s-03m29s.png

BEAT 49 — 03m29s-03m35s

He didn't return it. It wasn't bad. It just stopped registering as anything.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. The same box/item doodle icon as reference, drawn faded and grayscale, with a small neutral flat-line tag beside it (no emotion, just "still here"). No other text.

file: 049_03m29s-03m35s.png

BEAT 50 — 03m35s-03m41s

Leaf Van Boven and Thomas Gilovich — Cornell University — studied exactly this fade.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Two columns side by side: left column has a simple cardboard-box doodle icon labeled "THINGS"; right column has a simple plane-ticket doodle icon labeled "EXPERIENCES". No other text.

file: 050_03m35s-03m41s.png

BEAT 51 — 03m41s-03m48s

They compared people who spent money on things versus people who spent money on experiences.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9 title card composition, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. TITLE CARD. Bold oversized black marker text "THE 48-HOUR FADE" centered on plain white background. No other text.

file: 051_03m41s-03m48s.png

BEAT 52 — 03m48s-03m52s

Both groups felt the same happiness on day one.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. The same two columns as reference (left "THINGS" box icon, right "EXPERIENCES" ticket icon), now each with an identical bright smiley-face doodle icon above them, same height, with a small tag reading "DAY 1". No other text.

file: 052_03m48s-03m52s.png

BEAT 53 — 03m52s-03m56s

By the follow-up, the material purchases had faded. The experiences hadn't.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, blue, gray, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. The same two columns as reference (left "THINGS" box icon, right "EXPERIENCES" ticket icon), but now the smiley-face icon above THINGS is faded gray and flat, while the smiley-face icon above EXPERIENCES stays bright and yellow. No other text.

file: 053_03m52s-03m56s.png

BEAT 54 — 03m56s-03m59s

Not because objects are worthless.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. The same cardboard-box doodle icon as reference, with a bold

black marker label "WORTHLESS" beside it struck through with a thick red "X". No other text.

file: 054_03m56s-03m59s.png

BEAT 55 — 03m59s-04m04s

But because a static object gives your brain nothing new to predict.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. The same cardboard-box doodle icon as reference, with a small question-mark doodle above it struck through with a thick red "X", showing nothing left to predict. No other text.

file: 055_03m59s-04m04s.png

BEAT 56 — 04m04s-04m09s

Once it's sitting on your shelf, there's no "maybe" left in it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple wall-shelf doodle icon with the same cardboard-box item from reference sitting on it, a small empty black-outlined thought bubble floating above it with nothing inside. No text.

file: 056_04m04s-04m09s.png

BEAT 57 — 04m09s-04m12s

We call this the 48-Hour Fade.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Two simple doodle busts/portrait silhouettes side by side (round heads, minimal simple lines, no detailed faces), labeled below in bold black marker: "VAN BOVEN", "GILOVICH". A small building doodle icon beneath them tagged "CORNELL". No other text.

file: 057_04m09s-04m12s.png

BEAT 58 — 04m12s-04m17s

Alex has fourteen of these purchases sitting in drawers from this year alone.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple open-drawer doodle icon stuffed full with many small identical cardboard-box icons, a bold black marker tag "14" beside it. No other text.

file: 058_04m12s-04m17s.png

BEAT 59 — 04m17s-04m23s

Two thousand eight hundred seventy euros. Almost none of it still feels like anything.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9 title card composition, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. TITLE CARD. Bold oversized red marker text "€2,870" centered, with the small drawer-full-of-boxes icon from reference drawn faded and grayscale in the corner. No other text.

file: 059_04m17s-04m23s.png

BEAT 60 — 04m23s-04m27s

Fourteen separate "maybe" moments. Fourteen separate 3am checkouts.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A grid of 14 small identical notification-bell doodle icons, each with a tiny tag reading "3AM" beneath it. No other text.

file: 060_04m23s-04m27s.png

BEAT 61 — 04m27s-04m31s

None of the fourteen items were ever really the point.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same drawer-full-of-boxes icon as reference, with a bold black marker label "THE POINT" beside it struck through with a thick red "X". No other text.

file: 061_04m27s-04m31s.png

BEAT 62 — 04m31s-04m37s

They were just receipts for a feeling that had already happened hours earlier.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple receipt/paper doodle icon beside a small clock icon with a tag reading "HOURS EARLIER". No other text.

file: 062_04m31s-04m37s.png

BEAT 63 — 04m37s-04m42s

The trap doesn't feel like a trap. It feels like a virtue.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "2" as reference, now with a small halo/sparkle doodle drawn floating above it, giving it a falsely virtuous look. No other text.

file: 063_04m37s-04m42s.png

BEAT 64 — 04m42s-04m49s

"I earned this" sounds like self-respect. It's the Brain Villain, wearing self-respect as a costume.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, gold), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. CLOSE-UP. The same tiny pink blob "brain villain" character alone as reference, now wearing a small gold cape/costume sticker, a black-outlined speech bubble above it reading "I EARNED THIS", sly satisfied smirk. No other text.

file: 064_04m42s-04m49s.png

BEAT 65 — 04m49s-04m52s

Not because he doesn't appreciate what he owns.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same cardboard-box doodle icon as reference, with a small heart doodle icon beside it and a checkmark labeled "APPRECIATE". No other text.

file: 065_04m49s-04m52s.png

BEAT 66 — 04m52s-04m58s

But because appreciation was never the chemical that made him buy it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A small heart doodle icon struck through with a thick red marker "X", positioned beside a simple brain/chemical-flask doodle icon. No other text.

file: 066_04m52s-04m58s.png

BEAT 67 — 04m58s-05m04s

This is why the fifteenth sale notification works exactly as well as the first.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. The same notification banner icon as reference duplicated fifteen times in a row, all identical size, spanning the frame. No other text.

file: 067_04m58s-05m04s.png

PART 3 of 4 — Beats 68–100

BEAT 68 — 05m04s-05m12s

Each one is a brand new "maybe" — a fresh hit, unrelated to whether the last one satisfied you.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same notification banner icon as reference with a bold red marker stamp reading "NEW" across it. No other text besides the NEW stamp.

file: 068_05m04s-05m12s.png

BEAT 69 — 05m12s-05m17s

Your closet fills up. Your dopamine account resets to zero every time.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple closet/wardrobe doodle icon stuffed full of clothes on the left, and a round gauge/dial doodle icon pointing to "0" on the right, showing a reset. No other text besides the 0.

file: 069_05m12s-05m17s.png

BEAT 70 — 05m17s-05m24s

That's the second trap. It doesn't feel like the fade coming. It feels like relief.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "2" as reference, with a bold black marker label "RELIEF" beside it circled/highlighted, and a separate label "FADE" struck through with a thick red "X". No other text.

file: 070_05m17s-05m24s.png

BEAT 71 — 05m24s-05m30s

Here's the trap that doesn't announce itself, because it looks like the story ending well.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "3" as reference, disguised under a small green "happy ending" ribbon/ok-sign sticker covering most of it. No other text.

file: 071_05m24s-05m30s.png

BEAT 72 — 05m30s-05m34s

Go back to Schultz's monkeys for one more detail.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey, lightbulb, and juice-drop icons as reference, with a large magnifying-glass doodle icon hovering over the whole scene, revisiting the detail. No text.

file: 072_05m30s-05m34s.png

BEAT 73 — 05m34s-05m39s

Once the light reliably predicted the juice, something else happened.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same lightbulb and juice-drop icons as reference, connected by a solid green checkmark arrow showing the light reliably predicts the juice. No text.

file: 073_05m34s-05m39s.png

BEAT 74 — 05m39s-05m43s

The dopamine neurons went quiet — eventually, for the light too.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, gray, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same lightbulb icon as reference, now with its firing-spark burst crossed out with a thick red "X" and drawn dim/faded, matching the earlier fate of the juice-drop icon. No text.

file: 074_05m39s-05m43s.png

BEAT 75 — 05m43s-05m48s

A fully predictable reward stops producing the chemical at all.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon connected to a round gauge/dial icon pointing to "0", showing zero output. No other text besides the 0.

file: 075_05m43s-05m48s.png

BEAT 76 — 05m48s-05m52s

The system runs on uncertainty. Guaranteed good things bore it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon with a glowing "?" question-mark icon feeding energy into it on one side, and a gray flat "✓ guaranteed" checkmark icon with a small yawning-face doodle on the other side, looking bored. No text besides the question mark and checkmark.

file: 076_05m48s-05m52s.png

BEAT 77 — 05m52s-05m59s

So the day after Alex's package arrived and the excitement faded, his brain didn't rest.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex lies awake in a simple bed doodle, eyes open, restless. The tiny brain villain inside his transparent skull patch is agitated with small motion lines, not resting. No text.

file: 077_05m52s-05m59s.png

BEAT 78 — 05m59s-06m02s

It went looking for the next "maybe."

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex scrolls his phone again, a small magnifying-glass doodle icon hovering over the screen, searching expression. No text.

file: 078_05m59s-06m02s.png

BEAT 79 — 06m02s-06m04s

Not because Alex decided to.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Bold black marker words "ALEX DECIDED" struck through with a thick red marker "X". No other text.

file: 079_06m02s-06m04s.png

BEAT 80 — 06m04s-06m11s

But because a satisfied prediction system has nothing left to do but search for a new one.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon with a small magnifying-glass doodle icon attached to the side of it, as if the brain itself is searching. No text.

file: 080_06m04s-06m11s.png

BEAT 81 — 06m11s-06m15s

This isn't a lack of discipline. This is neuroscience.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple brain outline doodle icon labeled "NEUROSCIENCE" in bold

black marker, with a separate label "DISCIPLINE" struck through with a thick red "X" beside it. No other text.

file: 081_06m11s-06m15s.png

BEAT 82 — 06m15s-06m21s

It's a chemical system that treats "problem solved" as "please generate a new problem."

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A bold green checkmark doodle icon connected by a looping arrow back into a new bold black question-mark doodle icon, showing a solved problem generating a new one. No text.

file: 082_06m15s-06m21s.png

BEAT 83 — 06m21s-06m24s

We call this the Empty Refill.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9 title card composition, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. TITLE CARD. Bold oversized black marker text "THE EMPTY REFILL" centered, with a small doodle icon of an empty glass being refilled in the bottom corner. No other text.

file: 083_06m21s-06m24s.png

BEAT 84 — 06m24s-06m28s

It's the reason one purchase becomes three purchases becomes fourteen.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A growing row of cardboard-box doodle icons: first just 1 box, then an arrow to 3 boxes, then an arrow to 14 boxes, each group visibly larger than the last. No text besides the icons.

file: 084_06m24s-06m28s.png

BEAT 85 — 06m28s-06m30s

Not escalating want. Escalating search.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same magnifying-glass doodle icon as reference, drawn growing progressively larger across a row (small, medium, large), beside a small heart/"WANT" icon struck through with a thick red "X". No other text.

file: 085_06m28s-06m30s.png

BEAT 86 — 06m30s-06m35s

The scariest part: it feels like the opposite of a trap.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "3" as reference, with a bright green checkmark and a small smiley-face sticker overlaid on top, making it look harmless on the surface. No other text.

file: 086_06m30s-06m35s.png

BEAT 87 — 06m35s-06m43s

It feels like moving on — from one small treat to the next, healthily, like anyone would.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex walks casually, relaxed happy expression, holding a small treat/box doodle icon loosely in one hand. No text.

file: 087_06m35s-06m43s.png

BEAT 88 — 06m43s-06m48s

Alex would tell you he just likes finding good deals. That's not wrong.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely

high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex shrugs casually, a black-outlined speech bubble above his head reading "I JUST LIKE GOOD DEALS". No other text.

file: 088_06m43s-06m48s.png

BEAT 89 — 06m48s-06m53s

It's also exactly what the mechanism wants him to call it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP on Alex's head. The tiny pink brain villain visible inside his transparent skull patch leans close as if whispering, sly smirk, small dotted line from the villain's mouth toward Alex's ear. No text.

file: 089_06m48s-06m53s.png

BEAT 90 — 06m53s-06m59s

A system built to search never runs out of things to search for.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. A simple magnifying-glass doodle icon with a bold infinity-symbol loop drawn inside its lens. No text.

file: 090_06m53s-06m59s.png

BEAT 91 — 06m59s-07m06s

It's the trap nobody suspects, because it doesn't feel like fear, and it doesn't feel like relief.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same bear-trap doodle icon labeled "3" as reference, with two small labels beside it, "FEAR" and "RELIEF", both struck through with thick red "X" marks. No other text.

file: 091_06m59s-07m06s.png

BEAT 92 — 07m06s-07m10s

It feels like a person who just likes shopping.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex holds several shopping-bag doodle icons in both hands, casual happy pose. No text.

file: 092_07m06s-07m10s.png

BEAT 93 — 07m10s-07m14s

Same circuit. Same chemical. Wearing a completely different outfit.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same tiny pink blob "brain villain" character alone as reference (no Alex body, no legs), wearing three tiny different disguise props stacked or spread beside it — a small excitement-spark sticker, a relief-sigh sticker, and a tiny "moving on" walking-shoe sticker — faintly numbered "1", "2", "3" beneath each. No other text.

file: 093_07m10s-07m14s.png

BEAT 94 — 07m14s-07m16s

Now, an honest counter.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9 title card composition, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. TITLE CARD. A simple U-turn/flip arrow doodle icon beside bold black marker text "HONEST COUNTER", neutral calm tone. No other text.

file: 094_07m14s-07m16s.png

BEAT 95 — 07m16s-07m19s

Not every night purchase is the Maybe Hit.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same "THE MAYBE HIT" title card icon as reference, now with a bold black marker question mark/asterisk added beside it and a tag reading "NOT ALWAYS". No other text.

file: 095_07m16s-07m19s.png

BEAT 96 — 07m19s-07m29s

Real signal: you needed the item before you saw the notification, and you'd have bought it at full price next week anyway.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Bold black marker header text "REAL SIGNAL" above two small doodle icons: a calendar icon labeled "NEEDED IT BEFORE" and a price-tag icon labeled "FULL PRICE". No other text besides the header and these two labels.

file: 096_07m19s-07m29s.png

BEAT 97 — 07m29s-07m37s

Non-signal: you didn't know the product existed forty minutes ago, and there's a countdown timer on the screen.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Bold black marker header text "NOT A SIGNAL" above two small doodle icons: a surprised-face icon labeled "40 MIN AGO" and a countdown-timer clock icon with a red glow. No other text besides the header and these two labels.

file: 097_07m29s-07m37s.png

BEAT 98 — 07m37s-07m42s

This isn't a rule that says "never buy anything you feel excited about."

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Bold black marker text "NEVER BUY ANYTHING EXCITING" struck through with a thick red marker "X". No other text.

file: 098_07m37s-07m42s.png

BEAT 99 — 07m42s-07m50s

It's a rule that says: notice whether the want existed before the "maybe" showed up, or after.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, no characters. Two simple signpost doodle icons in the same style as reference: left signpost bold and solid labeled "BEFORE", right signpost faded/gray labeled "AFTER". No other text.

file: 099_07m42s-07m50s.png

BEAT 100 — 07m50s-07m55s

If you can name the need from yesterday — buy it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MEDIUM SHOT. Alex writes on a small notepad labeled "NEED:" in bold marker, a checkmark doodle icon beside him. No other text.

file: 100_07m50s-07m55s.png

PART 4 of 4 — Beats 101–133

BEAT 101 — 07m55s-08m03s

If the only thing that changed is a red countdown clock — that's the Brain Villain, not a need.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, pink), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same red countdown-timer clock icon as reference, with the tiny pink brain-villain blob peeking out from behind it, smirking. No text.

file: 101_07m55s-08m03s.png

BEAT 102 — 08m03s-08m07s

The goal was never to feel zero anticipation ever again.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same "THE MAYBE HIT" title card icon as reference, with a bold black marker label "NEVER FEEL IT" beside it struck through with a thick red "X". No other text.

file: 102_08m03s-08m07s.png

BEAT 103 — 08m07s-08m12s

Schultz's monkeys couldn't opt out of the mechanism. Neither can you.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, yellow, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same monkey doodle icon as reference, with a small door doodle icon beside it labeled "NO EXIT", crossed with a subtle red line. No other text.

file: 103_08m07s-08m12s.png

BEAT 104 — 08m12s-08m17s

The goal is noticing which moment the "yes" actually happened in.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. A small lightbulb doodle icon glows above Alex's head, aware knowing expression on his face. No text.

file: 104_08m12s-08m17s.png

BEAT 105 — 08m17s-08m22s

None of these three run alone. They're one loop, feeding itself.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The three title-card icons (Maybe Hit, 48-Hour Fade, Empty Refill) arranged in a circle, connected by thick curved black arrows forming a closed feeding loop. No other text.

file: 105_08m17s-08m22s.png

BEAT 106 — 08m22s-08m31s

The Maybe Hit is the operating system. The 48-Hour Fade and the Empty Refill are the applications running on top of it.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM, layered stack. The Maybe Hit title-card icon as a wide bottom layer labeled "OS" in bold marker. The 48-Hour Fade and Empty Refill icons stacked above it as smaller boxes labeled "APPS". Thick black connecting lines between layers.

file: 106_08m22s-08m31s.png

BEAT 107 — 08m31s-08m38s

That number again. Two thousand eight hundred seventy euros, on items that stopped registering within days.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast,

legible at small size. DIAGRAM. Same drawer full of small purchase icons as reference, with a huge bold marker figure "€2,870" above it, and a tiny calendar icon beside it showing a few crossed-off days. No other text.

file: 107_08m31s-08m38s.png

BEAT 108 — 08m38s-08m47s

Plus the hours spent scrolling for the next "maybe" — time that never shows up on any bank statement at all.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A large hourglass doodle icon with tiny phone-scrolling motion lines rising from it, next to a small paper "bank statement" icon with a big red zero "0" stamped on it. No other text.

file: 108_08m38s-08m47s.png

BEAT 109 — 08m47s-08m50s

Sit with that for a second.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. CLOSE-UP. Alex sitting still, chin resting on hand, thoughtful pensive expression, looking slightly downward. No text.

file: 109_08m47s-08m50s.png

BEAT 110 — 08m50s-08m54s

All three are powered by the exact same fuel.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A single battery/fuel-cell icon in the center labeled "UNCERTAINTY" in bold marker, with three thick wires branching out to three small icons: the Maybe Hit title, the 48-Hour Fade title, the Empty Refill title.

file: 110_08m50s-08m54s.png

BEAT 111 — 08m54s-09m00s

To your brain, uncertainty is not a distraction. Uncertainty is the entire reward.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A simple brain-blob icon labeled "REWARD" in bold marker, with a large question-mark icon flowing into it via an arrow labeled "UNCERTAINTY". A small crossed-out word "boredom" sits off to the side with a red X over it.

file: 111_08m54s-09m00s.png

BEAT 112 — 09m00s-09m04s

See the notification — the Maybe Hit fires immediately.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. Same phone notification banner icon as reference, with a bold lightning bolt shooting from it straight into the pink brain-villain blob, villain instantly lighting up. A small marker label "INSTANT" beside the bolt.

file: 112_09m00s-09m04s.png

BEAT 113 — 09m04s-09m08s

Own the object — the Fade sets in within 48 hours.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. Same cardboard package icon as reference, with a small clock beside it reading "48H", and the package rendered fading from solid color into pale gray/transparent outline. No other text.

file: 113_09m04s-09m08s.png

BEAT 114 — 09m08s-09m14s

Feel nothing left to want — the Empty Refill sends you looking again.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. An empty open box doodle icon with a magnifying glass hovering over it searching, a curved arrow looping from the empty box back around to a small notification-bell icon, forming a search-and-repeat cycle.

file: 114_09m08s-09m14s.png

BEAT 115 — 09m14s-09m20s

Every one of Alex's "treats" was the Brain Villain successfully doing its job.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MID SHOT. Alex smiling genuinely, holding a small wrapped gift box, happy expression. The brain villain in his skull patch giving a satisfied thumbs-up gesture. No text.

file: 115_09m14s-09m20s.png

BEAT 116 — 09m20s-09m24s

Just not the job his bank account actually needed.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A small wallet icon with a crossed-out frown face on it (sad, drained, red X), placed opposite a small happy face icon, contrasting the two. No text besides the icons.

file: 116_09m20s-09m24s.png

BEAT 117 — 09m24s-09m29s

None of this required Alex to be unhappy. That's what makes it invisible.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head — but this time the patch looks calm and empty, brain villain dormant/invisible, not glowing. MID SHOT. Alex smiling calmly, genuinely relaxed and content, no visible distress. No text.

file: 117_09m24s-09m29s.png

BEAT 118 — 09m29s-09m32s

It runs perfectly well disguised as contentment.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A pink brain-villain blob wearing a small comedic mask/costume drawn like a smiling face labeled "CONTENTMENT" in bold marker, subtly revealing its own smirk peeking from behind the mask. No other text.

file: 118_09m29s-09m32s.png

BEAT 119 — 09m32s-09m37s

And here's the part that has nothing to do with willpower.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A bicep/muscle-flex doodle icon labeled "WILLPOWER" crossed out with a thick red X, positioned separately from a plain gear/mechanism icon labeled "THE MECHANISM" with no X on it. No other text besides these labels.

file: 119_09m32s-09m37s.png

BEAT 120 — 09m37s-09m41s

Alex has more self-control than most people he knows.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely

high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MID SHOT. Alex standing confident, arms crossed, small yellow star badge doodle floating beside him. No text.

file: 120_09m37s-09m41s.png

BEAT 121 — 09m41s-09m46s

It didn't matter. The mechanism doesn't check for willpower before it fires.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside, actively glowing/lit regardless. MID SHOT. Same confident Alex with the yellow star badge beside him, but now a thick black arrow points from the badge straight to the still-glowing villain in his skull, unaffected. No text.

file: 121_09m41s-09m46s.png

BEAT 122 — 09m46s-09m53s

This scales with how many "maybes" reach your phone, not with how disciplined you are.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. Same calendar-with-red-dots icon as reference, but now the red dots multiply dramatically, clustering and overflowing off the bottom edge of the calendar, next to a small unchanged flat-line "discipline meter" gauge icon that stays level. No text.

file: 122_09m46s-09m53s.png

BEAT 123 — 09m53s-09m55s

The programs are not broken.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, gray, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. A plain clean gear/mechanism doodle icon with a bold green checkmark beside it. No other text.

file: 123_09m53s-09m55s.png

BEAT 124 — 09m55s-10m06s

They are perfectly designed for an environment where a new "maybe" — a berry bush, a chance encounter — was rare enough to be worth chasing.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, green, brown), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM/SCENE. A tiny prehistoric stick-figure human doodle standing beside a single berry bush, one glowing berry visible on it, wide empty plain landscape around, emphasizing rarity. No text.

file: 124_09m55s-10m06s.png

BEAT 125 — 10m06s-10m14s

Your phone now generates hundreds of "maybes" a day. Your brain still chases every one like it's rare.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, pink, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MID SHOT. Alex holding his phone, screen bursting with dozens of tiny overlapping notification icons and red dots exploding outward from it, slightly overwhelmed expression. No text.

file: 125_10m06s-10m14s.png

BEAT 126 — 10m14s-10m18s

Alex isn't shallow. Alex isn't bad at managing money.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. MID SHOT. Alex standing normal and calm, with two small word-labels floating away from him each crossed out with a red line: "SHALLOW" and "BAD WITH MONEY".

file: 126_10m14s-10m18s.png

BEAT 127 — 10m18s-10m28s

Alex has a brain built for a world with one rare "maybe" a month, running a phone that offers a hundred a day.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, green, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. SPLIT-FRAME DIAGRAM. Left half: the same lone prehistoric berry-bush scene as reference, small marker label "1/MONTH". Right half: the same phone bursting with dozens of notification icons as reference, small marker label "100/DAY". Thick black divider line down the middle.

file: 127_10m18s-10m28s.png

BEAT 128 — 10m28s-10m31s

The programs still work exactly as designed.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, green), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. Same clean gear/mechanism icon as reference, with a bold marker label "AS DESIGNED" beneath it and a green checkmark beside it. No other text.

file: 128_10m28s-10m31s.png

BEAT 129 — 10m31s-10m34s

They were just never designed for this.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, green, red), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The same gear/mechanism icon as reference, now beside a small "old world vs new world" pair of icons (a simple cave doodle crossed with a red arrow pointing to a smartphone doodle), with a bold marker label "NOT FOR THIS" underneath.

file: 129_10m31s-10m34s.png

BEAT 130 — 10m34s-10m37s

Same trap. Different label. Same result.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. DIAGRAM. The three title-card icons (Maybe Hit, 48-Hour Fade, Empty Refill) small and clustered together underneath one large umbrella-shaped banner labeled "SAME TRAP" in bold marker.

file: 130_10m34s-10m37s.png

BEAT 131 — 10m37s-10m41s

So which part of this is running in you tonight?

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, blue), plain solid white background except a dark near-black background here for a nighttime mood, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. Character Alex: round circle head, two small black dot eyes, thin flat mouth, small blue rectangle t-shirt patch, tiny transparent oval patch on top of his head showing a tiny pink blob "brain villain" with a smirk inside. EXTREME CLOSE-UP. Alex's face lit only by a faint cold glow, looking directly at the viewer, contemplative expression, mirroring the opening night scene. No text.

file: 131_10m37s-10m41s.png

BEAT 132 — 10m41s-10m50s

The excitement of the "maybe." The relief of the fade. Or the quiet refill that just feels like moving on.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple style, minimal flat colors only (black, pink, yellow, gray), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. THREE-PANEL TRIPTYCH DIAGRAM, thin black dividing lines between panels. Panel 1: glowing pink villain icon labeled "EXCITEMENT". Panel 2: a fading gray package icon labeled "RELIEF". Panel 3: an empty box with a magnifying glass icon labeled "MOVING ON".

file: 132_10m41s-10m50s.png

BEAT 133 — 10m50s-11m00s

Next week: why your brain treats your future self like a complete stranger — and why that's the real reason you don't save.

2D flat doodle illustration, thick uneven black marker/pen outlines, hand-drawn crude simple stick-figure style, minimal flat colors only (black, gray, blue), plain solid white background, no gradients, no shading, no photorealism, 16:9, extremely high contrast, legible at small size. SCENE. Alex standing facing a large mirror doodle, but the reflection is a foggy, blurred, faceless gray silhouette instead of a clear reflection, suggesting an unknown "future self". A small question mark floats near the foggy figure. No other text.

file: 133_10m50s-11m00s.png

END OF IMAGE PROMPTS · 133 beats